

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 159

By Southerland

A RESOLUTION to honor Thomas E. Mooty upon receiving the  
Cocke County Citizenship Award.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should specially recognize those estimable public servants who have dedicated themselves to improving the quality of life for their fellow citizens; and

WHEREAS, Thomas E. Mooty is being honored with the Cocke County Citizenship Award in recognition of his ongoing commitment to volunteerism, philanthropy, and community involvement; and

WHEREAS, Thomas Mooty has served with distinction as the pastor of West End Baptist Church in Newport for a combined total of approximately thirty-five years, and his record of public service, both in the past and the present, is impressive; and

WHEREAS, graduating with honors from Cocke County High School and lettering in band and football, Mr. Mooty further distinguished himself with honors at Tennessee Temple College when he graduated in 1976; and

WHEREAS, in an early token of his driven spirit, Mr. Mooty established his own lawncare business when he was fourteen years old, and he worked in various employments, including the City Park Pool and the Stokley-Van Camp Power House, until he decided to enlist in the U.S. Air Force, serving from 1961 to 1965 and exhibiting his willingness to lay down his life and serve his country in the ultimate capacity; and

WHEREAS, upon returning from his tour of duty, Mr. Mooty briefly continued his work in the utilities industry before hearing the call to ministry; after working part-time as pastor at West End Baptist Church, he gave himself fully to the endeavor when he became senior pastor in 1978, a position he filled with grace and steadfast compassion for nine years; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Mooty moved to become the very senior pastor of the First Baptist Church of Wartburg, and in his seventeen-year tenure, his abiding love and wisdom served well the people of God gathered there; and

WHEREAS, returning to his first pasture in 2004, Mr. Mooty is once more the senior pastor of West End Baptist Church, bringing his profound biblical knowledge and pastoral insight to his congregation and community; and

WHEREAS, deftly using multimedia to the service of the kingdom, Mr. Mooty has appeared on various radio and television programs over the years; these programs have been instrumental in his evangelical efforts and have exposed a wider audience to his powerful preaching and teaching; and

WHEREAS, even apart from his estimable role as a shepherd of souls, Mr. Mooty is a fixture of his community; for thirteen total years, he was the press box announcer for the Newport City Little League and Cocke County High School football and basketball, lending his steady voice to the cheers and jeers of local sports, and he helped to install, repair, and operate the stage lighting for performances at Cocke County High School; and

WHEREAS, his many accomplishments aside, he is fortunate to have shared a blissful forty-five years with his beloved wife, Anita Hollingsworth, before her passing in 2016; their fruitful marriage blessed the world with three children, Ed Mooty, Jolynn (Cal) Doty, and Lisa (Larry) Ottinger; six grandchildren, Sean Mooty, Caitlin Mooty, Charlee Doty, Savannah Doty, Gracie Ottinger, and Jack Ottinger; and one great-grandson, Crew Thomas Ottinger; and

WHEREAS, Thomas E. Mooty is wholly committed to the noble precepts of public service that have earned Tennessee recognition as the Volunteer State, and he should be recognized on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH  
GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF

REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor Thomas E. Mooty upon receiving the Cocke County Citizenship Award and salute his unswerving commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.